Zara's Back to School Escape

5 clues. 1 padlock. Be ready for the new term.



5 to 15 minute setup

Ages 8 to 13

Print and play

The classroom is locked. Solve five puzzles, crack the code, and open the door before the first day of term.

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TWO MINUTES BEFORE YOU PRINT

How to play, and the grown up guide



Detective, listen up. This is your mission. The classroom is locked with a five digit padlock. Each puzzle you solve hands you one digit. Solve all five, write the code, and you crack it open. Work in order, trust the clues, and no peeking at the answer key. Ready? Case open.

SETTING IT UP

Print the pages and go. You can laminate them and use a dry wipe pen so the mission plays again and again. There is nothing to hide and nothing to cut out. Just work through the puzzles in order, one to five.

HOW THE CODE WORKS

Every puzzle gives one number, the digit in the gold box at the bottom of the page. Write each digit in order onto the padlock on the finale page. Five digits, and the classroom door swings open.

GROWN UP TIPS

Read it together. For younger detectives, read each puzzle aloud and let them do the counting and the thinking. For older ones, hand it over and time them. Praise the effort, not just the answer. If they get stuck, point back to Zara's clue rather than giving the digit away. The joy is in the crack, not the copy.

ANSWER KEY · GROWN UPS ONLY

Puzzle 1 Count the supplies = 7 · three pencils, two rubbers, two glue sticks make seven.

Puzzle 2 Crack the word = 6 · the word is PENCIL, which has six letters.

Puzzle 3 Pack the PE bag = 5 · five items belong in the PE bag.

Puzzle 4 The timetable code = 3 · there are three maths lessons in the week.

Puzzle 5 Lunch money = 8 · two two pound coins and four one pound coins make eight pounds.

The padlock code is 7 6 5 3 8.

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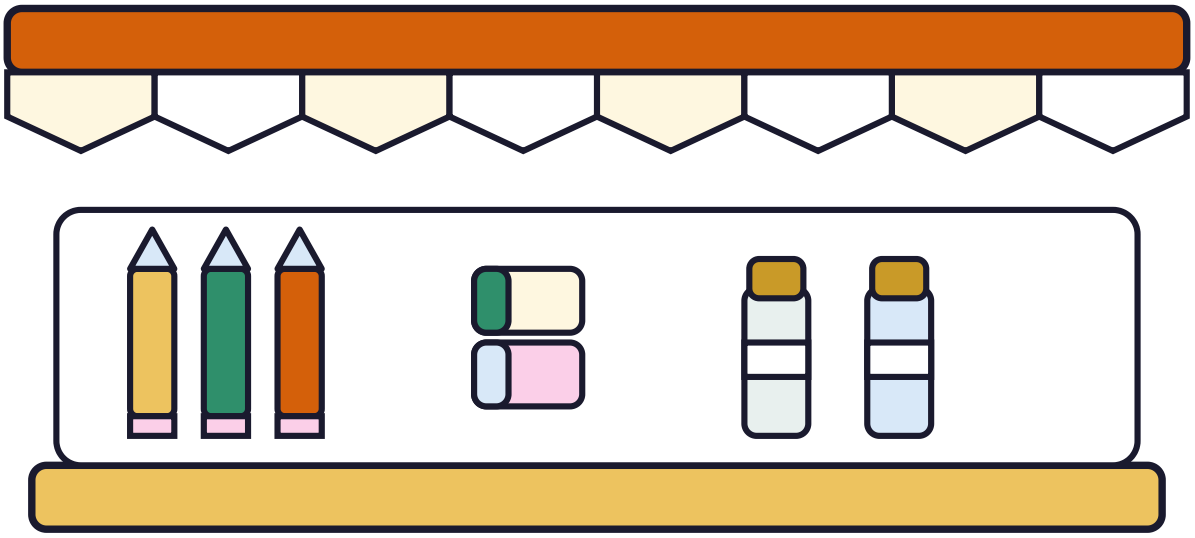
CLUE 1 OF 5

1

Count the supplies

First stop, the school supplies shop. The shopkeeper has laid everything on the counter. Count every single item on the stall. The total is your first digit. Careful now, detectives count twice.

THE BACK TO SCHOOL STALL



Count the pencils, the rubbers and the glue sticks. How many school supplies are on the stall in total?

My total: ☐

DIGIT 1

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